

better, but that day isn't here yet. The transfer rate of AirDrop is pegged at about 24 MBps. Yup, that's it. Extremely painful speeds when you consider USB 3 Flash drives can hit about 240 MBps.

However people using such services do know that they are trading off reliability, speed and quality all for the sheer convenience of not having to fiddle around with wires. The ability to do so much more without digging around for a physical bridge for data between two devices is an enticing option and the wireless future promises all that and more. These are but baby steps towards that direction and as such, an excellent way to tide us over till better options arrive.

Alternatives do exist

Do you also want to enjoy these Air shenanigans but can't afford to invest into the Apple ecosystem? Have no fear, because even Androids are starting to get on the AirPlay wagon. At Least HTC tried once... and it didn't end well to say the least. The idea was sound on paper but the flagship pricing makes people want to just pick up an iPhone straight up instead to get more out of it. But on the receiving side, you do have a lot of third party options the most famous and well regarded of which is AirFoil. Be warned it's just for audio streams though. You can also look at AirSync with the doubleTwist app and if you are willing to take it up a notch, you can whip together a streaming box for your TV with a Raspberry Pi that'll cost much cheaper than an Apple TV. For AirDrop, you'll have to deal with the clunkiness of ShareIT. Or go all in on cloud hosting services – provided you have the internet connection for it. 